

ALEXANDRA SIMONE GORDON

Instructional Designer | Professional Development Specialist | Special Education Advocate

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Portfolio: imalexofalltrades.netlify.app

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

K-12 instructional designer and professional development specialist with 10+ years of experience building educator capacity through evidence-based adult learning, literacy expertise, and sustained coaching. Deep background in special education advocacy and inclusive curriculum design, supporting students with disabilities and English Language Learners to achieve 85%+ annual academic growth. Proven track record scaling PD systems across 20+ school sites, achieving 95%+ educator engagement, and driving 200%+ gains in student outcomes. Expert in translating complex instructional frameworks into accessible, multi-modal learning experiences for K-12 educators, school leaders, and adult learners across in-person, remote, and hybrid settings. Offers a distinctive combination of practitioner credibility, systems-level design thinking, and a strengths-based approach grounded in trust, feedback, and collective buy-in.

WHAT I OFFER

- Special Education Advocacy & Policy Navigation
- IEP Development & Inclusive Curriculum Design
- Literacy Instruction for SWDs & ELLs (K-12)
- Differentiated Instruction & Universal Design for Learning
- Professional Development Design & Facilitation
- Adult Learning Theory (Andragogy, Strengths-Based)
- Instructional Coaching & Feedback Cycles
- Needs Analysis & Data-Driven Program Improvement
- Asynchronous, Hybrid & Remote Learning Design
- Cross-Functional Collaboration & Stakeholder Buy-In
- Curriculum Development & Standards Alignment
- Capacity Building at School, District & Program Level

SPECIAL EDUCATION ADVOCACY HIGHLIGHTS

- 10+ years advocating for students with disabilities across self-contained, ICT, and co-teaching models in NYC public schools serving high-need, low-income populations
- Expert in IEP development, implementation, and monitoring; regularly partnered with multidisciplinary teams to ensure legally mandated services were delivered with fidelity and adapted to individual student needs
- Developed and led professional learning on inclusive practices, Universal Design for Learning, and evidence-based reading instruction specifically for students with learning disabilities
- Selected by the NYC DOE CRSE Fellowship (1 of 50 city-wide) to develop culturally responsive, sustaining education curriculum for schools and communities across New York City
- Designed re-entry and bridge programming to successfully reintegrate students with disabilities into grade-level classroom settings
- Trained in social-emotional learning, trauma-informed practice, and co-teaching frameworks including push-in, pull-out, and parallel instruction models

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Instructional Designer & Special Education Advocate (Independent)

2025 – Present

Alex of All Trades

- **Special Education Advocacy Services:** Provide IEP audit, document review, meeting attendance, case management, and ongoing family coaching for families navigating the special education system; services grounded in 10+ years of IEP development and implementation across 5 NYC public schools in 3 boroughs.
- **Instructional Design & PD Consulting:** Design and deliver custom training modules, full curriculum, live PD workshops, and program consultation for K-12, nonprofit, and corporate clients; prior engagements have driven up to 238% improvements in learner outcomes.

- **Facilitator Coaching & AI Training:** Provide 1:1 facilitator coaching, train-the-trainer programs, and AI tools training, translating complex technical content into accessible learning experiences for educators and business professionals.
- **Zoom Production & Event Facilitation:** Produce and facilitate virtual events, webinars, and professional learning experiences, including full tech management, speaker support, live moderation, and post-event resource delivery.

Professional Learning Facilitator & Webinar Moderator

Nov 2025 – Present

The Mistral Collective (Freelance)

- **Adult Learning Facilitation:** Design and moderate live professional webinars for business executives on AI integration, applying adult learning theory, strengths-based facilitation, and iterative engagement strategies in a fully remote format.
- **Cross-Context Instructional Design:** Translate instructional design principles across audiences and contexts, adapting complex technical content into accessible learning experiences for senior-level adult learners alongside deep K-12 PD practice.

Senior Instructional Designer

July 2017 – January 2025

DREAM Program / SHSI, NYC Department of Education

- **Lead Instructional Designer:** Authored comprehensive, multi-modal ELA curriculum (including original proprietary reading frameworks WWH and COTS) for 4,000-5,000 students annually across 20 NYC sites in all five boroughs, driving the highest specialized high school acceptance rates in program history: a 238% improvement.
- **Proprietary Methodology Development:** Developed original reading strategy frameworks WWH (non-fiction roadmapping) and COTS (fiction roadmapping) for SHSAT test preparation; codified into training materials and taught to 90+ instructors across 20 sites, producing outcomes no previous program iteration had achieved.
- **PD Design & Facilitation:** Designed and facilitated onboarding PD for 90+ educators, grounded in strengths-based needs analysis and adult learning theory; 100% of participants demonstrated improved instructional practice on follow-up observation. Led 3 PD cycles per year, delivering 40+ unique workshops city-wide.
- **Observation & Feedback Systems:** Built scalable observation and feedback systems across 20 NYC school sites, achieving 95% instructor satisfaction and retention through iterative, strengths-based coaching cycles that fostered individual and collective buy-in.
- **Remote & Asynchronous Design:** Independently designed and coordinated asynchronous and hybrid learning content via Nearpod and Google Suite across 20 NYC sites, managing timelines and communications to ensure consistent curriculum access at scale.

Instructional Coach

Aug 2022 – June 2023

UFT Teacher Center, NYC Department of Education

- **PD Committee Chair:** Chaired a 10-person cross-departmental PD committee, co-designing adult-learning-centered workshops grounded in collective buy-in and strengths mapping; contributed to 95% educator engagement and an 80% increase in student outcomes.
- **New Teacher Onboarding:** Successfully transitioned 10 first-year instructors into the classroom through a full onboarding cycle; provided ongoing individual and small-group coaching to experienced teachers through formal coaching cycles including co-planning, co-teaching, and classroom intervisitation.
- **Technology Integration:** Designed and facilitated technology training workshops for 50+ instructors in asynchronous delivery, hybrid instruction, and self-guided learning tools, contributing to a 75% increase in technology integration and 200% improvement in learner engagement across 1,500+ students.
- **Community & Program Building:** Fostered a continuous learning culture through monthly staff newsletters, community events, and an instructional book study; designed and administered post-PD feedback tools that improved learner and instructor outcomes by 50%.

Special Education Teacher & Curriculum Designer

Aug 2014 – Jan 2025

NYC Department of Education (5 schools across Brooklyn, Queens, and Manhattan)

- **Schools Served:** Facing History School, Manhattan (2023-2025); Newcomers High School, Queens (2020-2023); New Voices School of Academic & Creative Arts, Brooklyn (2019-2020); Highland Park Community School, Brooklyn (2016-2019); Brownsville Collaborative Middle School, Brooklyn (2014-2016).

- **Special Education Advocacy:** Advocated for legally mandated instructional rights for students with disabilities across 10+ years, 5 NYC schools, and 3 boroughs; served as UFT Chapter Leader at two schools (2015-16 and 2024-25), building consultation, MOSL, Safety, and SLT committees from the ground up.
- **Inclusive Curriculum Design:** Designed and implemented standards-aligned, differentiated curriculum using co-teaching models and individualized content scaffolds tailored to each student's IEP goals, maintaining a 90% standardized test passing rate annually.
- **Literacy Instruction for SWDs & ELLs:** Supported 85%+ annual academic growth for students with reading disabilities and English Language Learners, including recently arrived immigrant students at Newcomers High School navigating new language and learning environments, through evidence-based literacy instruction across secondary grades 6-12.
- **Collaborative Curriculum Development:** Partnered with teams of 2-5 content-area teachers annually to develop 500+ standards-aligned, differentiated curriculum materials for 1,000+ diverse learners, adapting content to meet IEP requirements and individual learning needs.
- **Arts Integration & Grant-Funded Programming:** Secured Shubert Foundation grant (1 of 15 schools city-wide) to create a musical theater department, directing a sold-out production of 'Once on This Island'; secured Sing For Hope grant; organized Carnegie Hall programming through the Orpheus Chamber Concert Series; produced 'Poetry at the Met' (4 workshops at the Metropolitan Museum of Art).

EDUCATION

M.S., Special Education and Teaching

Long Island University, Brooklyn Campus | GPA: 3.91 | Graduated Summa Cum Laude
Social justice-focused program with emphasis on urban education and social-constructivist pedagogy

B.A., Cultural Anthropology

Binghamton University | GPA: 3.71 | Graduated Magna Cum Laude
Phi Eta Sigma Honors Society | Binghamton University Scholar

Certificate, TEFL: Teaching English as a Foreign Language

Via Lingua, Crete, Greece | 120-hour course with observed teaching practice

CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

NY State Secondary Special Ed Generalist (7-12)Level 3 Professional Teaching License	New Mexico Level 3 Professional Teaching LicenseAdobe Creative Educator Level 1	Google Certified EducatorCertified TEFL/TESOL/ESL
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TECHNOLOGY

- LMS: Google Classroom, Nearpod, Peardeck
 - Design & Content: Canva, Adobe Express
- Productivity: Google Suite, Microsoft Suite, Zoom
 - Asynchronous Delivery & Hybrid Instruction Platforms

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL LEARNING

- NYC DOE CRSE Fellowship: 1 of 50 educators city-wide selected to develop and disseminate culturally responsive, sustaining education practices
- Literacy Design Collaborative (2015-2016): Backwards design framework for meaningful, skill-based literacy curricula with structured coaching
- Urban Advantage Science Inquiry Training: Collaborative inquiry through partnerships between NYC public schools and cultural institutions
- Teachers College Inclusive Classrooms Project; IEP Workshops; Social Emotional Learning for All Students; Teaching Social Activism in the Classroom
- United Federation of Teachers Chapter Leadership Training: Led consultation, MOSL, Safety, and SLT committees